



Operations Division Monthly Report

Month: June 2026

1. Department Highlights and Achievements

Maintenance Division

Urban Forestry

- Completed tree removal and canopy up-limbing around the playground at Allsopp Park to improve safety and visibility.
- Responded to one streetlight trimming request and completed three Code Enforcement service requests.
- Removed dead trees surrounding Hindman Pond to improve public safety and enhance the park's appearance.

Mowing Crew

- Completed the scheduled mowing cycle for Kanis Park, Southside Park, and River Mountain Park.
- Prepared park facilities and amenities for upcoming reservations and special events.
- Performed skid steer operations around the Kiwanis Park pond to improve site conditions and maintenance access.

Horticulture

- Completed mowing and field setup at Interstate Sports Fields in preparation for scheduled activities.
- Mowed and maintained the splash pad area at Crump Park to ensure a clean and safe environment for visitors.



- Performed landscape grading and dirt work around the new playground at Allsopp Park to improve site appearance, drainage, and accessibility.

Trail Crew

- Removed hazardous trees along the River Mountain mountain bike trail and throughout the Rock Creek corridor to improve trail safety.
- Completed routine mowing and vegetation management along multiple trail systems, including the River Trail, Boyle Park trails, and other designated trail corridors.
- Mowed Murray Park and the trail corridor along Rebsamen Park Road to maintain safe and attractive public access.

Downtown District

- Completed landscaping improvements around the new playground at Allsopp Park.
- Installed a new bench at the Ozark Pavilion to enhance visitor amenities.
- Applied herbicide treatments to flower beds throughout the city as part of routine landscape maintenance and weed control.

Project Photos

(Before and After photos preferred)



Rock Creek Trail Cleanup



*River Mountain
Tree Removal*



Allsopp Park



Construction & Design Division

Maintenance Support

- Benny Craig: Work being completed on Fascia of Restroom
- Jim Dailey Fitness Center-Renovations completed at Jim Dailey Fitness Center to include new counter tops in the Mens locker room, Epoxy floor in the Lifeguard shack, outside restrooms painted, Diving board work completed
- Kanis Park Bleachers Boards Replaced
- Butler Park- Restroom Graffiti removed that covered the entire restroom
- Hindman Proshop: Demo of old carpet and cleanup has begun.
- Kiwanis: Pond leak has been fixed
- Murray: Fixed fitness area
- Meriweather: Bench repairs
- Secured Interstate Maintenance Building
- Murray Drinking Fountain on Order
- River Mountain Drinking Fountain on order



- Wakefield Graffiti removed from playground
- Sam Sanders in CDL training

Construction Crew

- Work at Reservoir Park on sidewalks and dirt work
- Benny Craig Tennis Courts and outfield fencing are demolished
- Murray Park: work being started on finishing of the sidewalks
- Dunbar: TV's hung and wall painted, shelving demo'd in upstairs room
- East Little Rock: Leak repaired and new ceiling tiles in place

Project Scheduler

- Electrical in progress for Dunbar and SouthWest Community Centers for Washer and Dryer setups
- Allsop Electrical repairs are underway for the Ballfield and the restroom after the service failed.
- Urban Forestry motorized garage door openers installed
- Miscellaneous plumbing completed at North Maintenance, Boyle Park, Rebsamen Golf, First Tee, Park Residences, and Jim Dailey.
- Dunbar HVAC Gym Units installed
- Jim Dailey Fitness Center Gym and locker room units installed.
- Arvest Restroom painting at Big Dam Bridge is completed.
- River Front Sculpture was set for completion on June 26th
- River Front Splash pad repairs completed
- River Front Electrical power and lights restored
- River Front Camera's outlets are with Staley Electric Scheduling

Contracted Projects

- Senior Center Renovation: Working with Architect and contractor on project credits, construction is moving forward with inter and exterior work.
- Murray Park Playground: New netting is completed. The finish work to start soon on the rest of the project
- Reservoir Park Restroom: Restroom is progressing and appears to be on time with applicable rain delay delays.
- Reservoir Park Playground: Turf to be installed after sidewalks are completed
- Reservoir Park Ballfield: Set to go for Board Communication
- Jim Dailey: Roof Project is underway and progressing
- Green Network Tree Planting has 1 bid and is currently being reviewed



- Bill Clark Wetland Boardwalk repair is going to Board Communication for moving forward
- Kanis Park Trail repave bids are closing June 29th.

Project Photos

Jim Dailey Counter Tops



Jim Dailey Roof Project



Reservoir Progress



Hindman Pro Shop Progress





Recognition

Team Member, Division, Department, or Resident Recognition

Recognized Individual/Group: Adam Gadberry- Horticulturist

Reason for Recognition: Email received from an Adpot-a-Flowerbed Volunteer



From: Mary Ellen Richards <maryellen.richards@gmail.com>

Sent: Thursday, June 18, 2026 4:46 PM

To: Couch, Leland <lcouch@littlerock.gov>

Subject: Adam Gadberry For President

EXTERNAL EMAIL - This email was sent by a person from outside your organization. Exercise caution when clicking links, opening attachments or taking further action, before validating its authenticity.



Leland:

I wanted to take a moment to recognize two members of your team, Adam Gadberry and Kevin, for the outstanding work they recently did at the bench and flower bed area in Allsopp Park.

As I have mentioned to you before, I am part of an Adopt-A-Flowerbed group that maintains the area around a memorial bench in the park. We wanted to refresh the bed for the summer by getting more plants, soil, and mulch, and I was told that Adam would be the best person to contact about that. Adam was not familiar with the area I was talking about since he had most recently been working downtown, but he immediately offered to meet me at the bench to see it firsthand. During that visit, he shared several ideas for improving the space, including ways to better define the flower bed, build up the area so we would have more soil to work with, and he recommended colorful plants that could survive the summer heat and sun. Adam worked on this with me over the past three weeks, and the results are fantastic!

Throughout the entire process, Adam was very responsive to my emails, calls, and texts and was consistently friendly and helpful. He kept me updated on what they would be doing and when, and he never made me feel like I was being a pest or inconveniencing him, which you and I both know I probably was.

Several members of our flower bed group regularly run or hike through Allsopp Park in the mornings, and if Adam saw them stopped at the bench, he took the time to talk with them and share updates about the project. Every person who spoke with him later commented on how friendly and kind he was. One of the first people Adam met at the bench was my friend, Melody. She and her husband installed the bench last summer in memory of their son, Sam. The rest of us then adopted the surrounding area as a flower bed as a way to support them. When Adam described their exchange to me and mentioned that she got a little teary, I told him who she was and how much that bench and garden area have meant to them. I could tell it resonated with him. He told me later that when he saw her down there again, he pointed her out to his crew so they would know that people care about the work they do and that it really does mean something. Melody has since told me several times how touched she is by the kindness and effort shown by everyone working on the project, particularly Adam. She appreciates not only the quality of the work, but also the compassion and care that the crew demonstrated while making an already meaningful place even more special. She absolutely loves it. As I told you before, I know we were extremely fortunate to catch Adam while so much work was being done on the playground area, but he still went above and beyond.

Despite everything else on his plate, he devoted time and attention to our project. He even went to three different nurseries to find the canna lilies he wanted us to use! And when he delivered them to me, he asked if I thought Melody would like them. It was so



thoughtful and another example of how much he genuinely cared about the project and its impact on people who cared about Sam.

I also want to give a shoutout to Kevin, whose last name I unfortunately do not know. (He has a beard and appears to be in his forties, maybe?) I spoke with him several times at the park and he was always friendly and eager to help with a big smile on his face. Kevin is a hard worker and moved several large rocks, trimmed a few tree branches around the area, and even created a deeper pool in the creek to make it easier for our volunteers to fill water jugs when caring for the flower bed. Like Adam, he seemed genuinely happy to help us.

The improvements to the bench area are wonderful, but what stands out most to me is the incredible kindness and genuine care that Adam, Kevin, and the rest of the crew demonstrated throughout the process. Their work made a visible difference in the park, but their generosity and kindness made an even greater impression on the people who love and care for this special place.

Although I told them myself, please pass along my sincere thanks and appreciation to both of them. You are lucky to have them representing the Little Rock Parks Department, and I wanted to make sure their efforts did not go unnoticed.

Thank you,
Mary Ellen

P.S. I am attaching a couple of photos for you. One is from March, where you can see we had some pansies, muhly grass, and two dwarf crepe myrtles (which you cannot see behind the bench) planted in the area. Adam's crew dug that up, put down big rocks that they repurposed from somewhere else in the park, unloaded some more soil, and replanted the crepe myrtles. Our group gathered the smaller rocks from the creek and placed them, then planted the bee balm, blanket flowers, and lilies that Adam brought us. Adam sent me a picture after they added mulch yesterday. As you can see, it is quite an improvement. We love it!



3. 2025 Goal Barriers

Goal: Reduce Litter in Parks

- **2025 Total:** 134 tons of litter collected
- **2026 YTD:** _____ tons collected

Current Barriers

- Limited employee hours, only two litter workers.

4. Unhoused Response Metrics

Operations

Metric	Total
Calls Received	__4__
Site Visits / Inspections	__3__
Camp Cleanups	__3__
Staff Hours	__12__
Cubic Yards of Debris Removed	__10__

Key Notes

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5. Work Order Metrics

Operations

Metric	Total
Calls Received	_____
Work Orders Completed	_____
Work Orders Outstanding	_____

6. Personnel Updates

Staffing, Vacancies, Employee Relations, and Other Issues

- Horticulture hired one Maint III position
 - Maintenance has offers to two Maint II positions
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7. Budget Update

Budget Needs, Challenges, and Opportunities

NEW 2026 BUDGET 06/29/2026					
	Acct	Budgeted	Actual Spent	Remaining	
DESIGN	104503	\$ 87,098.00	\$ 32,425.93	\$ 54,672.07	63%
DEV. & MAINT. ADMIN	104521	\$ 11,685.00	\$ 7,480.34	\$ 4,204.66	36%
OPERATIONS & IMPROV	104522	\$ 802,154.00	\$ 365,125.24	\$ 437,028.76	54%
PARK MAINTENANCE	104523	\$ 1,592,501.00	\$ 911,618.50	\$ 680,882.50	43%
HORTICULTURE	104524	\$ 229,390.00	\$ 101,849.60	\$ 127,540.40	56%
URBAN FORESTRY	104525	\$ 137,012.00	\$ 75,525.40	\$ 61,486.60	45%



8. Procurement Updates

Current and Upcoming Purchases, Bids, and Challenges

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9. Marketing & Communication Updates

Upcoming Events, Public Outreach, and Communication Needs

- July 7th Event
 - Future Allsopp Ribbon Cutting TDB
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10. Requests for Support / Additional Information

Items Requiring Leadership Attention or Assistance

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